

Robert Contant

West Springfield, MA | 774-383-1513 | robert.v.contant@gmail.com | www.robertcontant.com

Cybersecurity Engineer | Security Operations | Cloud Security | Incident Response

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 14+ years of combined experience across military security, signals intelligence, classified information protection, cybersecurity, information security, and GRC, including 9+ years building and maturing security programs for global software organizations. Focused on hands-on security operations, incident response, vulnerability management, cloud security, identity and access controls, Microsoft security tooling, and practical security automation. Experienced partnering with IT, CloudOps, engineering, legal, privacy, and external SOC/MDR teams to improve detection, response, hardening, remediation, and operational resilience. U.S. Marine Corps veteran with prior TS/SCI clearance.

CYBERSECURITY FOCUS AREAS

Security Operations & Incident Response: Incident Response, Threat Monitoring, SOC/MDR Coordination, Security Escalations, Phishing Simulations, Security Awareness, Operational Resilience

Cloud, Identity & Endpoint Security: Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365, Microsoft Defender, Defender for Cloud, Microsoft Sentinel, Entra ID, Intune, IAM, Endpoint Security, Logging & Monitoring

Vulnerability Management & Testing: Vulnerability Scanning, Penetration Testing Coordination, Risk-Based Remediation, Control Validation, Access Reviews, Password Security Reviews

Security Automation & AI Workflows: Langdock, AI-Assisted Workflows, Incident Report Drafting, Vendor Risk Reviews, Security Questionnaire Support, Policy/Procedure Drafting, Power Automate

Security Foundations: NIST Cybersecurity Framework, NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, SOC 2, Data Protection, Vendor Risk, BCP/DRP, Classified Information Protection

SELECTED CYBERSECURITY HIGHLIGHTS

- Report directly to the CIO while leading cybersecurity, security operations coordination, incident response, vendor risk, customer assurance, and compliance functions for a global software organization.
- Manage an external SOC/MDR relationship covering threat monitoring, incident response, vulnerability management, security escalations, and penetration testing coordination.
- Led multiple high-severity security and privacy incident response efforts involving investigation tracking, remediation oversight, executive coordination, and regulatory reporting support.
- Partner with IT, CloudOps, and engineering teams to improve Microsoft Defender, Defender for Cloud, Microsoft Sentinel, endpoint controls, cloud logging, and vulnerability management processes.
- Build AI-assisted security workflows to streamline incident reporting, vendor risk assessments, ISMS Q&A, contract/DPA review, and customer security questionnaire support.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Cybersecurity & Compliance

Apr 2025 to Present

XTEL - Remote - US

- Lead cybersecurity and security operations coordination across internal teams and an external SOC/MDR provider, including incident response, vulnerability management, security monitoring, and penetration testing.
- Coordinate vulnerability scanning and penetration testing across cloud, application, and infrastructure environments, ensuring appropriate scope, ownership, remediation tracking, and risk-based follow-up.
- Partner with IT, CloudOps, engineering, product, legal, and privacy stakeholders to integrate cybersecurity requirements into cloud operations, software delivery, customer commitments, and enterprise risk decisions.
- Work with IT and CloudOps to improve Microsoft Defender, Defender for Cloud, Microsoft Sentinel, endpoint controls, cloud logging, and vulnerability management processes; identify opportunities to reduce legacy cloud cost and attack surface.

- Run phishing simulation campaigns using Microsoft Attack Simulation Training and use results to improve security awareness and email security posture.
- Created and operationalized a vendor risk management program for third-party security reviews, risk tracking, evidence collection, and reporting.
- Reduced audit and assurance burden by consolidating external audit partners and aligning ISO 27001 and SOC 2 audit schedules to support combined evidence reuse and fewer control owner meetings.

Senior Manager - Risk & Compliance

Dec 2022 to Mar 2025

HCL Software - Remote - US

- Served as a security, risk, and compliance SME across SOC 2, data privacy, ISO 27001, ISO 27017, ISO 27018, and cloud control environments for global enterprise software teams.
- Partnered with technical and business stakeholders to assess access controls, operational risks, remediation plans, control design, and evidence quality across distributed product and infrastructure environments.
- Managed concurrent audits and assurance activities across multiple products, services, data centers, environments, and globally distributed technical teams.
- Identified more than \$750,000 in annual operational cost savings through risk-based review of technology, process, and control requirements.

IT Compliance Manager

Aug 2022 to Oct 2022

Documo - Remote - US

- Analyzed internal systems through manual and automated control testing against SOC 2, ISO 27001, HIPAA, GDPR, PCI DSS, and related security requirements.
- Developed risk management and vendor management programs and investigated potential security incidents as a member of the Incident Response Team.

Information Security & Compliance Lead

Nov 2020 to Jun 2022

Zoovu - Remote - US

- Built the company's security and compliance program in alignment with SOC 2 and ISO 27001, successfully obtaining the company's first SOC 2 Type II report within 12 months.
- Implemented endpoint protection controls across company computers and helped mature employee onboarding/offboarding, access review, and password security review processes.
- Created security awareness modules and phishing simulation campaigns to improve user security behavior and reduce social engineering risk.
- Investigated potential security incidents as part of the Incident Response Team and led testing sessions for Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity Plans.

Information Security Lead & Data Protection Officer

Feb 2017 to Nov 2020

Pera (formerly Seedlink) - Shanghai, China

- Built the company's security and compliance program in alignment with ISO 27001 while supporting global customer, legal, and data protection requirements.
- Coordinated penetration tests and internal/external audits while partnering with HR and business teams on secure onboarding, offboarding, and awareness processes.

Commercial Team Leader

Feb 2017 to Jun 2020

Pera (formerly Seedlink) - Shanghai, China

- Managed six direct reports and key accounts across Asia, Europe, and the Americas; expanded a key account to 15 countries and increased account revenue by more than 500%.

MILITARY SECURITY EXPERIENCE

Sergeant

Jun 2010 to Aug 2015

U.S. Marine Corps - Various Overseas Assignments

- Granted a Top Secret/TS SCI security clearance and served as a Signals Intelligence Operator with responsibilities involving classified information, data classification, encryption, analysis, and threat awareness.
- Served as a Marine Corps Embassy Security Guard for three years, protecting U.S. Embassies and Consulates in London, Shanghai, and Sarajevo.
- Supported high-profile security assignments for senior U.S. government officials, reinforcing judgment, composure, operational discipline, and protection of sensitive information.

PROJECTS & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

- Pursuing a Master of Science in Cybersecurity while building and documenting practical security projects through a portfolio website and GitHub.
- Build and maintain a personal cybersecurity homelab to deepen hands-on experience with networking, security tooling, monitoring, automation, and cloud/security workflows.
- Experiment with AI agents and automation to improve security operations, incident reporting, policy review, vendor risk analysis, and security documentation.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Cybersecurity <i>Bay Path University</i>	Oct 2025 to Present
Bachelor of Arts in Liberal Arts <i>University of Massachusetts Dartmouth</i>	Sep 2013 to Aug 2020
Chinese Language Program <i>Tongji University</i>	Sep 2015 to Jan 2016